

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The central question and conceptual grammar

CENTRAL QUESTION -> how does birth-based hierarchy reproduce itself,
and how do Gandhi and Ambedkar differently seek its transformation?

VARNA != JATI != CASTE != UNTOUCHABILITY

varna: textual classification | jati: local endogamous group

caste: order of birth, rank, occupation and closure

untouchability: intensified stigma and exclusion

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Reproduction: endogamy to graded inequality

endogamy -> inherited membership -> hereditary status
-> occupational closure + purity/pollution + sanction
-> division of labourers -> graded inequality
-> fractured solidarity and restricted free association
TRAP -> caste is not merely work division, class or prejudice.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Caste in democracy and the body politic

universal franchise -> political voice, representation, bargaining

caste power -> patronage, candidate selection, social blocs

ASSERTION for equal citizenship != DEFENCE of hereditary supremacy

class + gender interact with caste; neither erases its mechanism.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Gandhi's staged position

EARLIER -> idealised varna: hereditary duty, no asserted superiority

CAMPAIGN -> untouchability condemned; temple entry and common service

LATER -> increasingly critical of birth barriers; inter-caste marriage

RESIDUE -> inherited allocation can preserve closure despite denied rank

TERM -> 'Harijan' is historical usage and contested, not neutral.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Gandhian moral reform: argument and method

equal spiritual worth -> untouchability violates truth and ahimsa

-> privileged caste responsibility, repentance, self-purification

-> satyagraha + constructive programme + reinterpretation

STRENGTH -> moral responsibility and changed daily practice

LIMIT -> conscience does not guarantee rights, power or voice.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Ambedkar's caste diagnosis

Castes in India (1916) -> endogamy closes the marriage circle
closed circle -> caste reproduction -> status hierarchy
graded inequality -> each level has stake in distinction below
RESULT -> caste is anti-social and weakens public spirit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Annihilation rather than adjustment

Annihilation of Caste (1936) -> isolated reform leaves sanction intact
caste-sanctioning authority + endogamy + power must be confronted
inter-caste marriage attacks closure; education/organisation build agency
CONTROL -> reject imposed civic inferiority, not individual belief as such.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Ambedkar's social-democratic programme

rights + remedies -> protected action
representation -> autonomous political voice
constitutional morality -> civic norms above inherited authority
liberty + equality + fraternity -> social democracy
conversion (1956) -> ethical reconstruction, not mere ritual change.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: The Gandhi-Ambedkar matrix

TARGET: Gandhi untouchability/later barriers | Ambedkar caste itself
ROOT: corrupted conscience | endogamy, sanction, closure, power
AGENT: reformed society | autonomous oppressed organisation
METHOD: reform and non-violence | rights, representation, annihilation
DEMOCRACY: ethical fellowship | constitutional/social democracy

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Poona Pact and secular democracy

Communal Award (1932) -> separate electoral arrangements

Poona Pact (1932) -> joint electorate + reserved seats + primary-election mechanism

Gandhi: feared lasting separation | Ambedkar: feared dependent representatives

QUESTION -> who can choose a subordinated group's representatives?

TRAP -> interpret autonomy; do not narrate figures or harmony.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Safeguards, affirmative action and legal-status discipline

Article 17 -> constitutional rule abolishing untouchability

1989 Act, in force 1990 -> enacted protective penal statute

grounds -> compensatory | distributive | representational | anti-domination

Mandal = report | Indra Sawhney (1992) = judgment

103rd Amendment (2019) = enabling amendment | Janhit Abhiyan (2022) = judgment

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ answer spine and qualified conclusion

DEFINE -> name the exact caste mechanism or thinker-axis

DISTINGUISH -> varna/jati/caste; reform/annihilation; law/social change

ARGUE -> named anchor -> analysis -> objection/reply -> residual limit

COMPARE -> run common axes, never two biographies

CONCLUDE -> Ambedkarite structure and rights; moral transformation serves it

PYQ ROUTES -> factors, Gandhi, Ambedkar, annihilation, body politic, debate.